

Intimacy

Being emotionally and physically close to someone is a loving and exciting experience. Intimacy is a warm, affectionate type of closeness. It's a natural part of romantic relationships and can develop into something sexual.

Kissing

When two people kiss, it brings them close into one another's personal space. As well as the sensation of lips touching, kissing awakens a person's senses of smell and taste.



◀ Making out

A kiss can progress to tongues touching and exploring—sometimes called making out or French kissing.

Touching

As two people become more intimate with each other, the areas that they touch, and enjoying being touched, become more personal. From holding hands to caressing, these can be sweet or intense acts.



▷ Body contact

Touching intimate areas may start over and under clothes, progressing to undressing once both people feel ready.

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◀ 206–207 Sexuality

◀ 220–221 Consent

Sex

224–225 ▶

PARENT TIPS

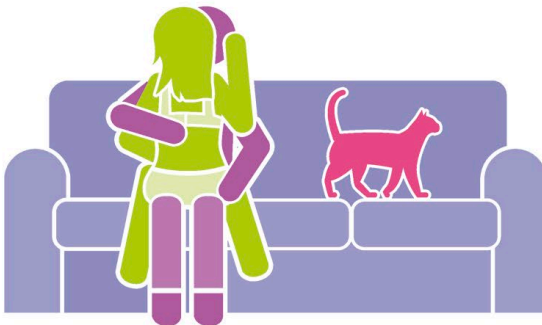
Parental concerns

It can be nerve-wracking to imagine your teen becoming intimate with a boyfriend or girlfriend.

- Teens who talk openly with their parents about sex and intimacy are more likely to delay sexual activity.
- If your teen wants to have sex, they probably will—regardless of efforts to dissuade them. Instead, try to emphasize consent, respect, having a personal connection with a partner, and contraceptive advice.

Foreplay

As the name suggests, foreplay often comes before sexual intercourse—but not always. It includes kissing and touching in ways that stimulate sexual arousal. It signifies a certain level of trust in the other person. Foreplay itself can be a satisfying end in itself rather than progressing to sex. As a step toward sex, it helps both partners become relaxed and feel ready.



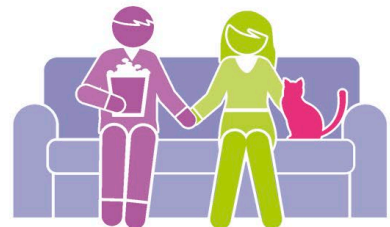
△ Fondling

Foreplay goes a step beyond kissing and touching, but doesn't necessarily lead to sex.

TEEN HINTS

That's far enough

People feel ready for different types and levels of intimacy at different times. Don't put pressure on yourself, or on your boyfriend or girlfriend, to do anything that you're both not fully comfortable with. Understand and respect what is right for you and for your partner. Be sure that neither of you just goes along with anything because you feel pressured or awkward.



△ Open and honest

Both parties need to be completely comfortable with the level of intimacy.